OUR LADY OF MONTLIGEON PRAYER GROUP- praying for all the souls in Purgatory meets in Termonbacca, on the last Wednesday each month at 12:30pm. Also in St Joseph's Church Galliagh every Monday after 11am Mass. All welcome

PILGRIMAGE TO LOURDES flying from Derry 3rd July - 8th £935 Contact Siobhan 07871656780

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel Michelle 07871765181.

DEEDS – Supporting the Carer Talk Series The third talk in our Carers Information Sessions, funded by the Western Health and Social Care Trust, will focus on future planning / advanced care planning. This information session will take place at the Old Library Trust Healthy Living Centre, Central Drive, Creggan, on Thursday 7th May 2026 at 7pm. For further information or to register, please contact Eilish on 02871373870 or email eilish@olt.ie.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

ALANON IT'S EASY TO SEE WHAT ALCOHOL IS DOING TO THE DRINKER BUT CAN YOU SEE WHAT IT IS DOING TO YOU? Are you afraid to upset someone for fear that it will set off a drinking bout? · For further information contact the Al Anon confidential helpline on 0800 0086 811 or email helpline@al-anonuk.org.uk . Alternatively, tel 028 9068 2368.

SAFEGUARDING Any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children and Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker) Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459
Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 99

PRIVACY NOTICE The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in Holy Family Church are available on line. Parishioners should note that the first 2 rows of seats are visible on line.

HOLY FAMILY CHURCH

Sun 3rd May 2026

Vol. 44 No 18

MASSES

Saturday Vigil 6.00pm
Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm
Mon ,Wed ,Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS

Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm
Tues ,Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm
Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS

Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES

Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE

71267070
1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ
Email:office@holyfamily-parish.com
Website: www. holyfamily-parish.com
Webcam: Click on website and follow the links
Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

FIFTH SUNDAY OF EASTER

"Do not let your hearts be troubled…" (John 14:1)

In this Easter season, the words of Jesus in John 14:1–12 speak directly into the uncertainties of our own lives. Addressing His disciples on the eve of His Passion, Christ offers not explanations, but reassurance: "Do not let your hearts be troubled. Trust in God; trust also in me." These are not distant words from the past—they are spoken anew to each of us today.

Jesus reveals Himself as "the way, the truth, and the life." For us as members of the Catholic Church, this is not only a statement of belief, but an invitation into relationship. Christ is the way we follow, the truth we receive, and the life we share—most especially through the sacraments. In the Eucharist, we do not simply remember Him; we encounter Him, truly present, drawing us into communion with the Father.

The promise of the "many rooms" in the Father's house reminds us that our faith is oriented toward a real and lasting home. Christ has gone before us, not to abandon us, but to prepare a place for us. This hope sustains us in times of grief, uncertainty, and change. We are not alone, nor are we without a destination.

As a parish community, may we take these words to heart. In our prayers, in the sacraments, and in our daily lives, may we trust more deeply, follow more closely, and love more generously—confident that Christ is with us, leading us home

BAPTISMS Our parish family welcomes: Finley James Moran, Gogarty Close Cael Anthony McCormick, Drumard Park.

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time Jim Mellon, Josephine Sweeney, Tony Horner, Mamie & Aidan Coyle, Eileen Kelly, Mary & Jim Wray, Renee McLaughlin, Jim Mellon Marie McGee

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD Our first reading tells the story of the selection of the first seven deacons. We pray for those recently, or soon to be, ordained to the Diaconate. Here in the Diocese of Derry we pray God's blessing on Deacon Stephen Baxter who will be ordained to the priesthood on 14 June, that the Lord will bless him in his future ministry.

SUNDAY COLLECTION 26th April £2262.30 Standing Orders £400 and €154.23 Thank you for your generosity

HOLY FAMILY SCRIPTURE GROUP on Thursday after 7.15pm Mass in the Upper Room This is a sacred time to come together to listen and reflect as Jesus speaks to each of us through His Word in scripture All welcome

THE LITTLE WAY NOVENA ***in St Eugene's Cathedral – 9th May to 17th May:*** The theme is ***'My peace consists in remaining little"***. The Novena will begin at the 7.30pm Mass with the Sacrament of the Sick on Saturday, 9th May. Devotions and talk on Sunday, 10th May at 6.00 pm. Monday to Friday (11th to 15th May) Novena Masses at 6.30 am and 10.00 am each morning and an evening service with a guest speaker at 7.30 pm. Saturday, 16th May 10.00 am Mass for those who have died. The Novena will close on Sunday with blessing of the roses, 17th May at 3.00 pm. Everyone is welcome to St Eugene's Cathedral for this time of prayer and petition.

A **MARIAN EVENING OF PRAYER** will be held in **St Mary's Church,** . **Creggan**, on **Wednesday, 13 May** (Feast of Our Lady of Fatima). The event is hosted by Derry Youth Ministry, who are preparing for their diocesan pilgrimage to Fatima in August of this year. The night will begin at **7:00pm** with a rosary procession (outdoors, weather permitting), followed by a short talk on Our Lady and the Eucharist, Adoration, and Benediction. Music will be provided by the Diocesan Youth music group, with refreshments following in the community room. All welcome! Contact Bethany at bethany.doherty@derrydiocese.org for more details.

DERRY DIOCESAN PILGRIMAGE TO KNOCK SHRINE will take place on Saturday 6 June. In conjunction with the All Ireland Rosary Rally, we will join those gathered to celebrate at our National Eucharistic and Marian Shrine. For those for whom it is convenient, buses will leave St Eugene's Cathedral, at 8:00am: cost £50, which includes dinner in Knock House Hotel following the conclusion of the Mass in the Basilica. For further information, please contact Karen in the parish office at St Eugene's on 028 7126 2894 or by email at cathedral@derrydiocese.org.

PRAY IN MAY WITH MARY'S MEALS Mary's Meals is currently feeding over 3 million children daily around the world. During May, Mary's Meals invites you to pray for children worldwide who rely on a daily meal to access education and for those still waiting. A range of free prayer resources including themed prayers, rosary reflections and a prayer calendar for May have been created, to enable families and individuals to take part. They are available at www.marysmeals.org.uk/prayinmay or contact Caoimhe on 07394564065.

SINCERE THANKS from Sister Ann to ALL who contributed in any way to our Easter Mission Appeal in aid of the poor in Kenya, India, Nigeria and Haiti. Total amount raised is £11006 and €935 Thank you SO much. May God reward and bless you once again for all your generosity

FOYLE FOOD BANK has written to thank you for all the donations received during the Lenten appeal. They received 141 kg of donations. Thank you for your generosity